



January 2006

Where Have You Been?

This is the first time I have bought *Digit*. And I must say that I am a fool not to have bought it earlier! I will be buying a computer later this month, but even without a computer, this magazine is a gold mine of information. Already, I know details of so many things that I had only heard of earlier. Your article about HDTV, air flow inside a computer cabinet, and the review of Flash drives were immensely useful.

Also very interesting was the article about Intel's prediction for the sales of its quad-core processors.

I congratulate your editing team for presenting purely technical matters in a language understandable by a layman like me.

A very useful feature of your articles and reviews is that prices of products are mentioned. This enables me to make informed decisions, and also bargain better when someone is trying to rip me off by quoting sky-high prices.

I read that with your December issue you have given a CD with soft copies of 23 issues of *Digit*. I want some information about the differences and advantages of dual-core processors vis-à-vis the newer Core 2 Duo processors. Will I find the information in that CD?

I don't have the December copy but I am currently trying to obtain one. I have already written to Agent001 for details about what kind of computer to buy and I am sure *Digit* will be my constant reference guide once I start using it.

I also read a letter from another subscriber bemoaning the profusion of advertisements in the magazine. I would like to say that the adverts are very useful since they provide information to people like me who are not aware about the various products available in the market.

Thanks for a wonderful magazine and keep up the good work!

Raj
Pune

Dear Raj,

It was nice to know that *Digit* enchanted you in its first attempt. We are glad to know that you do like our articles and the way we present them. Few people take the initiative to write a positive mail—and you're one among them. It is easy to criticise but difficult to take the effort to write appreciation—thanks to you to have done it! It does motivate us to hear congratulatory words from our readers—makes us feel our job and efforts are worth it.

The December 2006 CD, which had an archive of our past 23 issues and all our *Fast Track* issues, might not explicitly mention the merits and demerits of Core 2 Duo, but we have certainly reviewed Core 2 Duo and Core Duo in our November 2006 issue. Do read that particular article if you get hold of our December 2006 mag with its archive CD.

Thanks for your feedback—and do keep mailing, even if it is to criticise us, though we hope that we will never give you that opportunity!

— Executive Editor

The Vietnam Connection

A year ago I used to walk into a computer examination hall with shaking hands and an immobile body... and now it is one of those tests which I strive to perform at. And you know who deserves the pat on the back? Not me, nor my computer book, but the entire *Team Digit*. Your software usage tours, and Tips & Tricks have certainly taken me to greater heights.

Earlier, I used to see my film-editing partner (I'm learning film-making on Adobe Premier Pro 2.0) begging his senior for a copy of *Digit*... and I used to wonder, "Why?" Then I decided to take a sip of the magazine myself, and couldn't resist—I had to drink the whole glass! And what's more, I discovered the CD, DVD and *Fast Track* books...couldn't do anything other than request my parents to subscribe for me.

At first, they seemed unsure if they were doing the right thing, but then I showed them the magazine and told them about the contents... and guess what... they agreed (who wouldn't?).

I really liked your July issue, and grew curious about Google SketchUp. So, when my dad was going to India (while I was living in Vietnam), I asked him to get me the December Issue. And

I found Google SketchUp in that!!! I immediately tried it, and attached to this mail is the picture of the house I've designed in that—please do comment!

I really wish to ask you to include some good editing software in your next CD or DVD, and please, please, please put in some new movies, 'cause I am actually allergic to oldies!

I really liked the new interface of the CD's this time—they're awesome!

One last thing—this is a true thing that happened with me... there are two shops, both sell software. One sells originals, one pirated. They are right opposite each other. The software I need costs Rs 45,000 (converted rate) at the original software showroom, and just Rs 45 at the pirated software shop. Both work perfectly, but the original has fancy packaging. Tell me—what should I do?

Once again, thank you.

Jaskunwar Kohli
Welham Boys' School
Dehradun

Dear Jaskunwar,

It's heartening to know that our issues being read all the way in Vietnam—I admire your passion and determination to overcome your fear of computers.

We have taken a note of all your requests, and will try and implement them soon.

Regarding the piracy issue—it's like taking a decision on whether to cheat or not. I can understand the heavy price of being honest, but what if one day you develop software, or create a brilliant architectural design that someone pirates and illegally sells for cheaper? How would you feel? I hope you get my point.

I know that certain software companies have inflated prices, but that's still no excuse for piracy. Perhaps you should look for an alternative, maybe an open source option.

As far as providing new movies on the DVD goes, we will, provided we get permission to do so. Generally, the only movies released are under Creative Commons licenses. Regarding new movies in our CD, well, it requires express permission from producers, which is difficult to come by—they want lots of money to share their collection. So we will have to make do with some old ones as of now.

— Executive Editor

Expensive?

Although I am not a subscriber of *Digit*, I have read almost all your issues. To be frank, I have only missed issues when I